

TEPI AGRICULTURAL RESEARCH CENTER

TARCMS

Tepi Agricultural Research Center Management System

PROJECT CONCEPT, PURPOSE, IMPORTANCE & FUNCTIONAL OVERVIEW

A non-technical document explaining what the project is, why it matters, who it serves, what it provides, and its proposed functions.

Prepared for: Tepi Agricultural Research Center

Purpose: Internship project concept and institutional presentation

Scope note: This document describes the proposed TARCMS system. Center-specific names, staff lists, exact research programs, vehicle inventories, photographs, contact details and internal procedures should be confirmed by the Center before being treated as official information.

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

TARCMS is a proposed digital management and public information platform for the Tepi Agricultural Research Center. The project is intended to bring important institutional information and selected management activities into one organized, accessible and maintainable system.

The system serves two major purposes. First, it provides the public with reliable information about the Center, its research activities, people, publications, news, events and other approved institutional content. Second, it provides authorized Center personnel with a controlled place to maintain information and manage selected records.

The idea is therefore broader than creating a normal website. TARCMS is intended to become a digital institutional platform that improves how information is presented, maintained, discovered and shared.

2. PROJECT NAME

TARCMS stands for **Tepi Agricultural Research Center Management System**.

The name reflects the wider purpose of the project: the system is not limited to displaying information. It combines a public-facing institutional presence with management capabilities for selected Center information and activities.

3. THE PROBLEM THE PROJECT ADDRESSES

Agricultural research institutions generate valuable information: research programs, projects, publications, staff expertise, events, announcements, institutional history and other resources. When information is difficult to find, outdated, scattered across different channels or dependent on manual communication, its value is reduced.

TARCMS addresses this challenge by proposing one organized digital platform where approved information can be presented to the public and maintained by authorized users.

The system is also intended to reduce dependence on static pages that require technical changes whenever institutional information needs updating. With a management dashboard, authorized personnel can maintain content more systematically.

4. IMPORTANCE TO THE INSTITUTE

- **Institutional visibility:** presents the Center, its research activities and achievements through a professional digital presence.
- **Information organization:** brings important institutional information into a structured system.
- **Content maintenance:** lets authorized personnel update approved information without rebuilding the whole website.
- **Research visibility:** makes research programs, projects and publications easier to discover.
- **Staff visibility:** provides a structured way to present approved staff information and expertise.
- **Communication:** provides a clear channel for news, events and contact messages.
- **Institutional memory:** creates an organized digital record of selected content.
- **Operational support:** selected modules such as vehicles can organize internal records.
- **Decision support:** dashboard summaries can help authorized personnel see current information quickly.
- **Future growth:** the platform can later be expanded when new needs are identified.

5. IMPORTANCE TO RESEARCHERS

- Researchers can discover information about research programs and projects.
- Publications can be organized so research outputs are easier to find.

- Research areas and institutional activities can be presented in one place.
- Events and announcements can help researchers stay informed.
- Contact information can make communication with the Center easier.

6. IMPORTANCE TO STUDENTS AND LEARNERS

- Students can learn about agricultural research activities and institutional programs.
- The system can expose young people to research work and scientific outputs.
- Publications and project information can support academic exploration.
- An organized institutional website can help students understand the Center's role.

7. IMPORTANCE TO FARMERS AND THE COMMUNITY

The public value of an agricultural research center depends partly on how effectively its work can be communicated. TARCMS can provide a clear public channel for approved research information, institutional announcements, events, publications and contact information.

- Community members can learn what the Center does.
- Visitors can find contact and location information more easily.
- Research achievements can be communicated beyond the institution.
- Public announcements and events can be presented in an organized way.
- Information that the Center chooses to make public becomes easier to discover.

8. IMPORTANCE TO PARTNERS AND OTHER INSTITUTIONS

Agricultural research frequently involves collaboration and information exchange. A professional institutional platform can make it easier for potential partners, researchers, government bodies, universities and other organizations to understand the Center's activities and identify appropriate points of contact.

9. WHO WILL USE TARCMS?

Public visitors: people who want information about the Center, research, publications, news, events, gallery and contact details.

Center management: authorized personnel who need management information and selected administrative functions.

System administrators: authorized personnel responsible for maintaining system content and settings.

Researchers and staff: information consumers and, where authorized, contributors to institutional content.

Students, partners and community members: users who primarily consume approved public information.

Note: exact internal responsibilities and permissions should be confirmed by the Center.

10. PUBLIC WEBSITE — WHAT PEOPLE WILL SEE

The public side is the Center's digital front door. It should be welcoming, professional, accessible and focused on useful institutional information.

Home: Introduces the Center, highlights important research/content and directs visitors to key information.

About: Explains approved background, mission, vision, objectives and institutional identity.

Director: Presents an approved director/leadership message and profile.

Departments: Shows departments or organizational units and their descriptions.

Research Programs: Presents research areas/programs and their purpose.

Projects: Presents approved research projects and their information.

Publications: Provides an organized presentation of research publications.

News: Communicates institutional announcements and important updates.

Events: Presents upcoming and past events where appropriate.

Gallery: Displays approved photographs and media.

Contact: Provides official contact information and a visitor message form.

11. MANAGEMENT SIDE — WHAT THE CENTER CAN MANAGE

The management side is for authorized users. It is where selected information shown on the public website can be maintained and selected internal records can be organized.

Dashboard: Provides an overview of important information, summaries and quick actions.

Staff: Maintains approved staff records and related information.

Departments: Maintains department information.

Research Programs: Maintains research program information.

Projects: Maintains research project records.

Publications: Maintains publication records and related files where approved.

News: Creates and manages institutional news.

Events: Creates and manages events.

Gallery: Manages approved images and media.

Vehicles: Maintains selected vehicle/resource information for internal management.

Messages: Allows authorized users to review contact messages.

Settings: Manages selected system/institution configuration.

Profile: Allows an authenticated user to manage their own profile.

12. STAFF MANAGEMENT

Staff information is important because people are central to research. The proposed staff module can organize approved information such as name, position, department, professional description, areas of expertise and photograph.

Exact fields should be approved by the Center. Sensitive personal information should not be collected simply because it is technically possible.

13. RESEARCH PROGRAM MANAGEMENT

The research program module provides a structured way to describe the Center's research areas. Each program can have a title, description, objectives, responsible department/team and links to related projects where appropriate.

14. RESEARCH PROJECT MANAGEMENT

Projects represent specific research activities. The system can organize approved project information such as title, description, research program, responsible team, dates, status and related outputs.

15. PUBLICATION MANAGEMENT

Publications are major research outputs. TARCMS can provide a structured publication catalog containing information such as title, authors, year, publication type, description/abstract, related project and optional document or external reference.

16. NEWS AND EVENTS

News provides a channel for announcements, achievements, institutional updates and other approved communication. Events can communicate meetings, workshops, conferences, field activities, training and other approved activities.

17. GALLERY

The gallery provides a visual record of approved Center activities, facilities, research work, events and other institutional moments. Images should be uploaded with appropriate permission and descriptive information.

18. VEHICLE MANAGEMENT

The proposed vehicle module is an internal management feature. It can organize basic vehicle/resource records such as registration identifier, vehicle type, assigned department/responsibility, status and other fields approved by the Center.

The project should not invent vehicle inventories. Actual vehicles, fields and management procedures must come from the Center.

19. CONTACT AND MESSAGE MANAGEMENT

The contact module connects the public website with the institution. Visitors can submit a message through an approved contact form, while authorized personnel can review and manage incoming messages.

20. INFORMATION FLOW

Institution provides/approves information → authorized user enters/updates it → system stores it → approved content is published → public visitor views it.

Visitor opens Contact → submits message → system validates/stores message → authorized user reviews it → Center responds through its normal process.

21. EXPECTED BENEFITS

- Better public access to institutional information.
- Improved visibility of agricultural research.
- More organized management of website content.
- Centralized presentation of projects and publications.
- Improved communication through news, events and contact messages.
- Better presentation of staff and institutional expertise.
- Reduced dependence on manually edited static pages.
- More consistent institutional branding and presentation.
- Foundation for future digital services.
- Improved readiness for future expansion.

22. WHAT MAKES TARCMS DIFFERENT FROM A NORMAL WEBSITE?

A normal institutional website may primarily display fixed pages. TARCMS is intended to combine public information delivery with controlled content and selected management functions.

- Content can be maintained through an authorized management interface.
- Research information is organized into programs, projects and publications.
- Staff and organizational information can be maintained systematically.
- News, events and gallery content can be updated.
- Contact messages can be collected and managed.
- Selected operational information such as vehicles can be organized.
- The system can grow into additional institutional modules later.

23. FUTURE POSSIBILITIES

If the Center later identifies a need, the platform could be expanded with inventory, laboratory management, attendance, document management, equipment, procurement, finance-related records, reporting, research monitoring or a mobile application. These are future possibilities, not claims that they are part of the current system.

24. INFORMATION THAT MUST COME FROM THE CENTER

For TARCMS to become an accurate institutional system, the Center should provide or approve:

- Official institutional name and description.
- Logo and approved branding.
- Director/leadership information.
- Department names and descriptions.
- Staff list and approved profiles.
- Research programs.
- Research projects.
- Publications and research outputs.
- News and events.
- Approved photographs and gallery material.
- Vehicle records and fields the Center wants to manage.
- Official contact information.
- Which information is public and which is internal.
- Who is authorized to manage each type of information.

25. PRIVACY AND RESPONSIBLE INFORMATION MANAGEMENT

Because TARCMS may contain staff, operational and communication information, the Center should decide what is appropriate to store and display. Personal or sensitive information should be minimized, protected and only exposed to authorized users.

Photographs, documents and other media should be used with appropriate institutional permission. Public information should be separated from internal information.

26. SUCCESS MEASURES

- A visitor can understand what the Center does within a few minutes.
- A visitor can find research programs, projects and publications easily.
- Important announcements and events can be published and maintained.
- Authorized staff can update approved content without changing source code.
- Contact messages can be received and reviewed.
- Information is organized consistently.
- Access to internal functions is restricted.
- The Center can maintain the platform after the internship with appropriate training and documentation.

27. PROJECT LIMITATIONS

TARCMS should not be presented as replacing every existing administrative system at the Center. Its initial scope is the public institutional platform plus selected management functions. Additional systems such as finance, laboratory, HR, procurement or inventory should only be added after requirements are properly gathered.

28. CONCLUSION

TARCMS is proposed as a digital platform that can strengthen the Tepi Agricultural Research Center's public communication, research visibility, information organization and selected internal management activities.

For the public, its value is easier access to useful institutional information. For researchers and students, its value is improved discovery of research programs, projects and publications. For the Center, its value is a more organized and maintainable digital presence combined with selected management capabilities.

The most important principle is that the system should be built around the Center's real needs. Official Center information, workflows, permissions and content must therefore be confirmed by the institution before the system is treated as an operational production system.

29. ONE-PAGE PROJECT SUMMARY

Project	TARCMS — Tepi Agricultural Research Center Management System
Purpose	Digital institutional information and selected management platform
Primary users	Public visitors, researchers, students, partners, Center management and authorized administrators
Public side	Home, About, Director, Departments, Research Programs, Projects, Publications, News, Events, Gallery, Contact

Management side	Dashboard, Staff, Departments, Research Programs, Projects, Publications, News, Events, Gallery, Vehicles, Messages, Settings, Profile
Main value	Research visibility, organized information, communication, maintainable content and selected internal record management
Future direction	Additional institutional modules based on verified Center requirements